THE RAMAKRISHNA CENTRE OF SOUTH AFRICA

JOHANNESBURG

KEY INSIGHTS FROM THE SEMINAR | 16 AUGUST 2026

THE IMPORTANCE OF SPIRITUAL EDUCATION *for Children*

The Ramakrishna Centre of South Africa - Johannesburg recently held a seminar on "The Importance of Spiritual Education for Children" on Sunday,16 August 2026 at the Vodacom Business Park, Midrand. Approximately 150 delegates, including parents, educators and community leaders, participated in the Seminar reaffirming the continuing importance of value-based education for children.



"We want that education by which character is formed, strength of mind is increased, the intellect is expanded, and by which one can stand on one's own feet."

- Swami Vivekananda

Foundations of Spiritual Education

Children need more than information. They need values, character, purpose and inner strength.

1. THE HOME IS THE FIRST SCHOOL

Children learn most deeply from what they see.

- Parents are the child's first teachers.
- Love, respect and trust should permeate family life.
- Consistent behaviour is more powerful than instruction.
- The greatest legacy parents can leave is their own character.

2. VALUES MUST BE LIVED, NOT MERELY TAUGHT

Information alone does not transform character. Children develop values when they:

- Observe them
- Reflect on them
- Practise them repeatedly
- Internalise them as habits

Values become effective when they move from ideas into daily life.

3. EVERY CHILD IS INHERENTLY DIVINE

Children should be reminded continually that:

- They possess innate dignity and worth.
- Divinity exists within every person.
- Spiritual growth begins with self-respect.
- Questions should be welcomed and explored with patience and understanding.

4. TEACHING MUST BE AGE APPROPRIATE

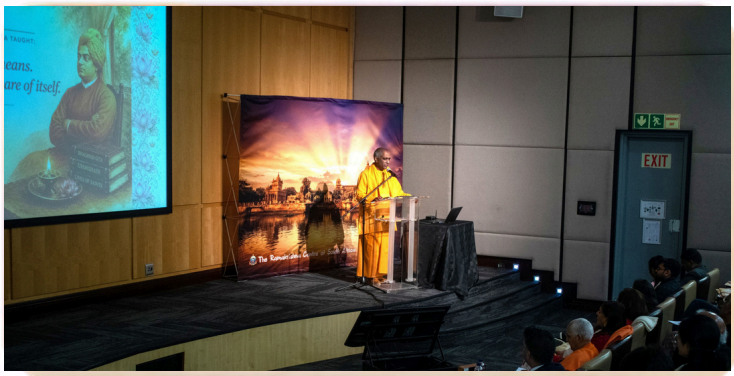
Spiritual education should grow with the child. Recommended approaches include:

- Inspiring life stories.
- Introduction to Hindu values and traditions.
- Learning from the Ramayana, Mahabharata, Gita, etc.
- Creative and engaging learning resources.

VOICES FROM THE SEMINAR

Seminar Topics

The Seminar covered a range of topics, which encompass the holistic development of a child.





MRS RAGINI HARIBHAI

A devotee and voluntary worker of the Sri Sarada Devi Ashram, Durban. Mrs Haribhai has spent significant time teaching young children and helping to co-create the "Hinduism for Children" syllabus.

Paper 1: The Necessity and Role of Religious Education for Children

MR M K ANGAJAN

An internationally renowned Vedanta philosopher who bridges ancient Eastern wisdom and modern corporate leadership, helping individuals master themselves, achieve clarity and find inner peace.

Paper 2: The Role of Parents in Establishing and Developing an Incubator for Spiritual Education Within the Home

REVERED SWAMI VIPRANANDA

Monk in Charge of the Ramakrishna Centre of South Africa - Johannesburg. Swamiji was a senior educator at Sri Ramakrishna Vidyashala (Mysure, India), a premier education institute.

Paper 3: Effective Methods for Imparting Spiritual Education to Children

REVERED PRAVRAJIKA ISHTAPRANA MATAJI

Head of the Sri Sarada Devi Ashram, Durban. Revered Mataji has overseen the Centre's "Hinduism for Children" classes for over four decades.

Paper 4: Choosing the Right Teaching Resources for Age-Appropriate Spiritual Education

“Education is the manifestation of the perfection already in man.”

- Swami Vivekananda







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